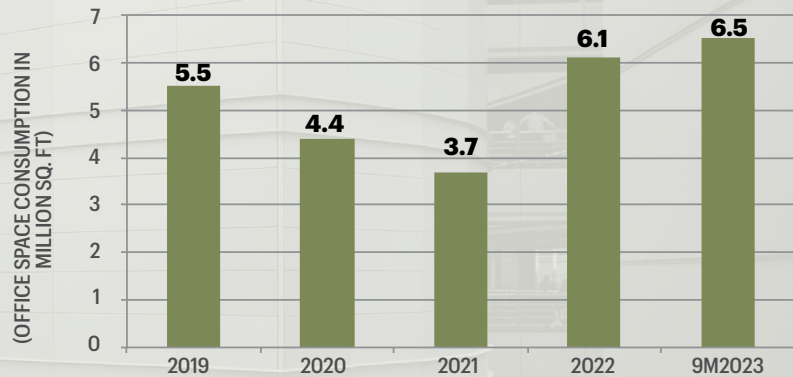


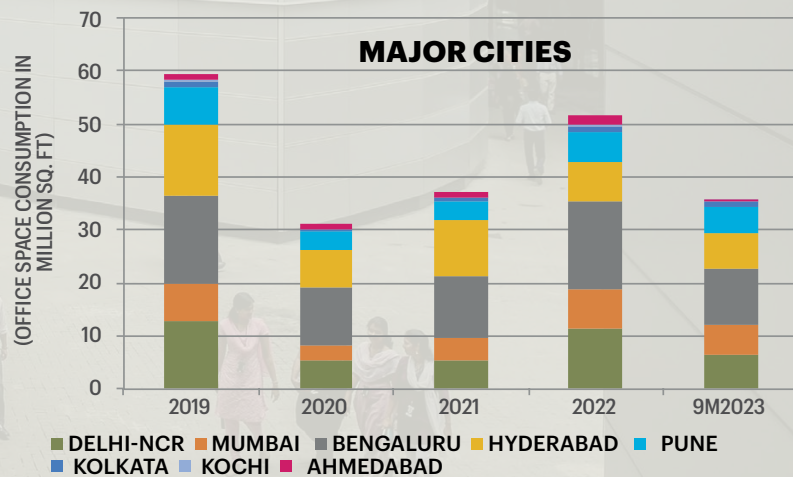
BUILDING BOOM

► In the first nine months of 2023, Chennai has already surpassed its entire 2022 consumption

CHENNAI



MAJOR CITIES



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sumer of managed office spaces, Chennai is a much more diversified market, appealing to a wide range of businesses. “Demand growth is coming not just from the IT sector but also from banking, logistics, manufacturing, engineering, SaaS and GCC firms,” says Rishi Das, Co-founder and CEO of IndiQube. The Bengaluru-based flexi working space provider, which has been ramping up capacity in the city, plans to add 20,000 seats over the next two years.

On the other hand, the market in Bengaluru is overwhelmingly dominated by start-ups and IT firms. Further away, Hyderabad is also an MNC- and pharma-driven market. Experts say these firms tend to grow in short and fast cycles, which means these markets heat up and cool down quickly. Expensive financial capital Mumbai is more suited for head offices and smaller centres, while companies scale up elsewhere. Pune is

again skewed towards MNCs and offshore development centres, while Gurugram is the only portion of Delhi-NCR witnessing growth in office space. Das says Chennai’s diversity ensures that the market does not crash even when things are not going great. “It’s a level-headed market. That is why we have been able to scale up so well in Chennai to 20,000 seats.”

W HILE THE IT TREND continues in the city, albeit at a much slower pace than last year, Chennai is also attracting attention from global banks. The UK-based Standard Chartered Global Business Services (StanChart GBS) is opening its biggest campus globally in the city. The 740,000 sq. ft facility at the upcoming DLF Downtown in Taramani, scheduled to open in